

The Tantra King Called 'The Black Karma of Yamāri, the Enemy of the Lord of Death, Which Accomplishes All Through the Wheel'

Yamāri Kṛṣṇakarma Sarva Cakra Siddha Kara Nāma Tantra Rāja · Toh 473 · Derge Kangyur
གཤམ་རི་རྩེ་གི་ཤད་དག་རྒྱ་ག་པ་འོ་ལའ་ལོ་ལོ་ས་ཐམས་ཅད་གསུ་པར་བརྟེ་པ་ཞེས་བ་བྱའ་རིན་པོ་ལུ་ཀྱུ་པོ་

Toh 473 in the Kangyur is a tantric text known in Sanskrit as the Yamāri Kṛṣṇakarma Sarva Cakra Siddha Kara Nāma Tantra Rāja, and in Tibetan as the tantra king called "The Black Karma of Yamāri, the Enemy of the Lord of Death, Which Accomplishes All Through the Wheel." It belongs to the class of Buddhist tantric literature and centers on Yamāri, a wrathful deity who conquers Yama, the lord of death, with the text presenting teachings on ritual accomplishment through the mandala or wheel associated with this deity's dark, or black, activity. The text opens in the characteristic sutra-style framing of tantric scriptures, with the Buddha figure identified as the Blessed One surrounded by a vast assembly of vajra deities and mothers, suggesting an elaborate tantric setting concerned with the transformation of the five poisons and the elements into awakened qualities. As a tantra king, it represents a prestige category within the Kangyur's collection of tantric scriptures, relating to the Yamāri cycle of practice that was influential in Indian and Tibetan Buddhism.

In the language of India: Yamāri Kṛṣṇakarma Sarva Cakra Siddha Kara Nāma Tantra Rāja. In the Tibetan language: The Tantra King Called "The Black Karma of Yamāri, the Enemy of the Lord of Death, Which Accomplishes All Through the Wheel."

Homage to the Blessed One, Vajra Ḍākinī.

Thus did I hear. At one time, the Blessed One — together with Vajra Delusion, Vajra Avarice, Vajra Attachment, Vajra Aversion, Vajra Envy, Vajra Earth, Vajra Water, Vajra Fire, Vajra Wind, the mother who is Great Bliss of awakening mind, the mother who is Garland of Qualities, the mother who satisfies the stream of mind, the mother who is the essence of diligence, the mother who is Incense, the mother who is Flowers, the mother who is Butter-Lamps, the mother who is Perfumed Water, and immeasurable others — all abided together in the bhaga of the noble lady Vajra, who is the body, speech, and mind vajra of all Tathāgatas, the Blessed One.

Then the goddess Vaitālī rose from her seat, joined her palms together, and addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, at this present time malevolent beings harm all sentient beings, and in times to come as well, those who harm both practitioners of the Great Vehicle and all sentient beings will arise. How shall they be vanquished?"

Then the Blessed One entered the meditative absorption called "Vanquishing All Obstructing Spirits," and from the vajra of his own body, speech, and mind he drew forth this essence: Hrīḥ. Instantly the Blessed One himself transformed into the aspect of one with six faces, six arms, and six feet, struck down the second Mahābhairava, and together with crushing Mahābhairava along with his consort, he uttered Oṃ Hrīḥ Ṣṭhī Vikṛtānana Hūṃ Hūṃ Phaṭ Phaṭ Svāhā with a great laugh, uttering Oṃ and pressing down.

All gods, asuras, and māras trembled and shook, and bowed down. Brahmā, Śakra (Indra), and all others likewise paid homage and bowed down.

Then the Blessed One, the wrathful king,
the greatly terrifying and great one,
endowed with great compassion,
proclaimed these words:

"Now I shall explain the practice.

Meditate upon the hub at the center of the eight-spoked wheel,
visualizing oneself with six arms and six faces,
and likewise six feet.

In the first right hand a vajra hammer;
in the second right hand a sword;
likewise the first left hand holds a lasso with the threatening finger-gesture;
the second grasps a stake firmly;
the last holds a vajra bell.

The topmost face is black and terrifying;
two feet are in vajra cross-legged posture,
and with four feet performing a dance of stepping out and drawing in.
Completely wrapped in tiger skin,
with a golden lion-mane
gathered and rising upward,
the crown too is bound with a garland of skulls.

This is the wrathful one in his wild aspect,
bearing weapons of many kinds.
On the four spokes — east and the rest —
the four such as Delusion and so forth,
white, yellow, red,
and likewise the fourth is green;
in the right hands: a blazing jewel wheel,
a manifold lotus, and a vajra;
in the left hands, holding a bell with grace.
At the intermediate directions, those born of Lam and the rest —
the four goddesses are to be firmly visualized.

Similar to the lord in their alluring aspect,
the goddess of the corner, at her mark,
is playful, with a clenched fist at her waist,
bearing a garland of jewels in her two hands,
her melodious voice like a vīṇā playing,
spreading out in dance,
always diligent for the benefit of beings.
Incense and the rest — the four of them too —
each firmly holding their own attributes,
through the recitation of their mudrā mantras.

Then again the Blessed One, the Lord of all Tathāgatas, proclaimed this
mantra of Vajra Delusion:

Oṃ Jina Jik..."

Then again the Blessed One, the Lord of all Tathāgatas, proclaimed this
mantra of Vajra Miserliness:

Oṃ Ratna Dhṛk.

Then again the Blessed One, the Lord of all Tathāgatas, proclaimed this
mantra of Vajra Attachment:

Oṃ Ārolīk.

Then again the Blessed One, the Lord of all Tathāgatas, proclaimed this
mantra of Vajra Envy:

Oṃ Prajñā Dhṛk.

Then again the Blessed One, the Lord of all Tathāgatas, proclaimed this mantra of Vajra Earth:

Oṃ Locanā Hūṃ.

Then again the Blessed One, the Lord of all Tathāgatas, proclaimed this mantra of Vajra Water:

Oṃ Āmākī Trāṃ.

Then again the Blessed One, the Lord of all Tathāgatas, proclaimed this mantra of Vajra Fire:

Oṃ Paṇḍari Vāhri Hrīḥ.

Then again the Blessed One, the Lord of all Tathāgatas, proclaimed this mantra of Vajra Wind:

Oṃ Tārā Āḥ.

Then again the Blessed One, the Lord of all Tathāgatas, proclaimed this mantra of the one who generates great bliss:

Oṃ Lāsyē.

Then again the Blessed One, the Lord of all Tathāgatas, proclaimed this mantra of the Garland of Qualities:

Oṃ Māle.

Then again the Blessed One, the Lord of all Tathāgatas, proclaimed this mantra of the Melodious One:

Oṃ Gīti.

Then again the Blessed One, the Lord of all Tathāgatas, proclaimed this mantra of the Dance Goddess:

Oṃ Nṛtye.

Then the Blessed One, the Lord of all Tathāgatas, proclaimed these mantras of offering:

Oṃ Vajra Dhūpe. Oṃ Vajra Puṣpe. Oṃ Vajra Dīpe. Oṃ Vajra Gandhe.

Then again the Blessed One proclaimed these mantras — the mantra for summoning all, the mantra for entering all Tathāgatas, the mantra for binding all Tathāgatas, and the mantra for delighting all Tathāgatas — the Blessed One, the Lord of all Tathāgatas, proclaimed them:

Oṃ Vajra Oṃ Kuśa Jaḥ. Oṃ Vajra Pāśa Hūṃ. Oṃ Vajra Sphoṭa Bhaṃ. Oṃ Vajra
Āveśa Hoḥ.

The skilled and intelligent one, as best he can,
shall set down the lines upon the lines.
With measured cords, free of knots,
smooth and sharp they render it beautiful.
Looking to the east, one draws the first.
The second brahma-line too
is to be drawn looking toward the south.
Below that, the line of the border is drawn —
standing in the auspicious position, one looks with commanding gaze.
Where the wind abides, look away from the false direction
and draw well toward the west.
Standing there, looking toward the east,
draw toward the north and stand in the auspicious position.
The final line is drawn not in the false direction —
the looking is toward the direction free of falseness.
The teacher's companion, not rising,
sits facing the direction of the deer-rider,
and there draws the first brahma-line.
The second also sits facing the false-free direction
and draws it along the direction of obstacles, legs extended.
The defining characteristic of the palace
divided into center and periphery:
it is made foursquare, adorned
with four gates and four archways.
At the hub of the eight spokes in the center
one draws a vajra hammer.
In the very center of the solar disc
one draws also a curved blade.
On the eastern spoke, the great wheel;
on the southern spoke, a jewel;
on the western, a red lotus;
on the northern, a vajra with all its prongs.
In the southeast quadrant, likewise.
In all four corners, the eight symbols
are drawn in double tier with care.

At each of the four gates one draws
a hook, a noose, a chain, and a bell,
and all other adornments too are drawn with care.
The offerings are to be arranged beautifully.
With fists placed upon the two hips —
likewise pressing to the forehead,
drawing out from the mouth, moving in dance,
fumigating with incense, pressing, and scattering flowers,
with thumbs raised, and upon one's own body too —
the manner of pressing upon others:
these are the mudrās for generating
and for the proper placing of the eight goddess-offering consorts.
The deities of body, speech, and mind
are made to enter and abide within one's own body;
blessing them with mantra is performed as follows:

Om sarva tathāgata kāya vajra svabhāva ātmako'ham.

Om sarva tathāgata vāk vajra svabhāvā ātmako'ham.

Om sarva tathāgata citta vajra svabhāvā ātmako'ham.

For the blessing of the eyes and the other sense faculties,
protection is effected by the Delusion Vajra and the others.
Having made the empowerment-accomplishment an emptiness,
the forms are to be definitively generated
as bearing the clan's emblem — those bearing the seed syllables
or the syllables of the name.

Then the Blessed One, Master of all the Tathāgatas, entered into the
meditative absorption called Tasting the Nectar and spoke this mantra:

Om Āḥ Hūṃ.

Examine it as purified and blazing.
In the center of the solar maṇḍala
abides the master of the aversion-vajra.
In the center of the moon, visualize delusion.
In the center of the jewel, likewise,
visualize it as miserliness itself.
In the center of the lotus, visualize attachment.
In the center of the variegated, visualize envy.

The seed syllables are on the tongue of that which is to be visualized;
by the emanation, draw them in and bring satisfaction.

The east is great white.

The south is assuredly yellow.

Know the west to be certainly red.

The north possesses the perfect green.

From that, likewise, the sequence of the rekhā lines —
when meditating on the maṇḍala as well,
through the sequence of the four immeasurables —
loving-kindness, compassion, joy, and equanimity —
in order to benefit sentient beings,
visualize all things, both stable and moving,
as neither existent nor non-existent,
not both, and not neither —
free from conceptual elaboration, without essential nature.

Om śūnyatā jñāna vajra svabhāvā ātmako'ham.

From the syllable Raṃ, meditate fully on the sun.

From its center arises the karma-vajra,
whose nature is altogether five-pointed.

From its center, from Hūṃ, the vajra —
by its fineness, obstacles are utterly destroyed.

The fence, the tent, and the ground as well —
visualize them definitively below it.

The upward-pointing white triangle,
I visualize as exceedingly clear.

From aversion, what has not previously arisen shall not arise,
and what has arisen shall not arise again.

One inclines toward the awakening mind,
gives and is free from the pride of hearing.

Sloth is overcome and anger is absent.

Free from miserliness, free from deceit.

Guile is abandoned, wisdom shines clearly,
and one inclines wholeheartedly to the Great Vehicle.

Then, even without difficulty,
if one undertakes this for the sake of others,

through the secret mantras complete in fourteen sets
of ten million each in full count,
all activities are accomplished without doubt.

Then the goddess addressed the Blessed One with these words: What is the
yantra (mechanical device) of that like? How are the syllables to be written?

The Blessed One declared: One should write a grid well arranged in sets of
seven, each set having seven. For the wheel that performs all activities, make
excellent offerings; thereafter the activities are to be undertaken. When a sign
in a dream of recitation or a direct sign has arisen, these are the dream signs
indicating that the yantras should be drawn: encountering great forests and
thorn-filled islands, temples, stupas, and perfect palace-maṇḍalas; meeting
with holy ones and receiving empowerment; ascending a mountain; crossing a
river joined to the ocean; dreaming of barbarians taken as servants — upon
these signs, the yantra is certain to be accomplished; draw it.

Then the Blessed One again taught the meditation on the elemental maṇḍalas.

From the syllable Yaṃ, the wind maṇḍala arises —
blue in color, bow-shaped in form;
visualize it as bearing banners.

From the syllable Raṃ, the fire maṇḍala arises —
triangular, red in color — visualize it thus.

From the syllable Baṃ arises water,
white in color, round in form — visualize it thus.

From the syllable Laṃ arises the earth maṇḍala:
yellow-green, four-sided — having visualized it thus,
first visualize in sequence as described.

Then meditate on Tvarita from the outside inward with certainty.

At the hub of the wheel arisen from the syllable Bhruṃ,
endowed with twelve spokes,
from Bhruṃ arises the palace-mansion;
the practitioner should visualize it as furnished with a throne.

Then again the Blessed One gathered the Sugata together with his retinue by
means of the vajra-gathering mudrā and mantra:

Oṃ vajra samājah.

The two palms are crossed with certainty,
the two index fingers bent in the form of a hook;
snap the fingers and perform the gathering.
With the four forms — hook and so forth —
perform the drawing-in and so forth with certainty.

Then again the Blessed One, as lord of all Tathāgatas, spoke this mantra of offering:

Oṃ arghaṃ pratīccha svāhā. Pravara satkāra pratīccha svāhā.

A pot that is black and without rim,
large-bellied and of a bre measure,
with a hanging spout and long neck, furnished with a seat —
fill it with essential medicines and the like.
Wrap fine cloth around its neck.

A sprig endowed with leaves,
a mouth-ornament fragrant with scent —
with these, together with amṛta, make offering.

With a fine parasol, victory banners,
pennants, cymbals, and musical instruments,
with reverence make offering to the maṇḍala as well.
Whether Jambudvīpa or other continents
filled with precious jewels,
the trichilocosm and so forth in the same way —
offer these without timidity.

The wise practitioner, with a mind intent on benefiting sentient beings,
shall not take life,
shall not take what is not given,
shall not engage in sensual misconduct, shall not speak falsehood,
and — since it is the cause of harm — shall not drink alcohol.
Turn beings back from all that is vicious.

Whether directly or through mantra and other means,
through mechanical devices and meditative absorption,
or through medicine — these are the activities to be performed.
One who does not act in this way
will certainly suffer the ruin of their samaya commitments.
Through malevolent spirits and misleading influences too,
they will surely die and in hell

be tormented by suffering for a long time.

Therefore, with diligence,

without generating patience for them but with compassion,
one must slay them decisively with mantra.

Abiding in an irreversible mind,

moistened by the water of awakening,

leaning upon the great mudrā of the Perfection of Wisdom,
destroy phenomena that are devoid of inherent nature.

In receiving what has not been freely given — that is, awakening —
abandon laziness and strive with diligence.

Know phenomena to be false;

then speak of them to others accordingly.

To phenomena that are sealed,

turn your back, and with the sword of wisdom,

cut through them; I have proclaimed that even slaying that which is without
form

is permissible.

Write the vowel letters beginning from the upper right;

write the lower letters beginning from the left.

Write the vowels and consonants with certainty.

The center, excepting Kṣaḥ and Ma, is left empty.

In that center, write with certainty

the name-sign of the obstructing spirit (vighnakarṭṛ)

or its name and so forth;

write it so that it is enclosed within the belly.

Write the wheel likewise;

in its four corners, write

the neuter forms of the Kāli of desire —

the Āli is not these; these are the remainder.

Write the fourteen fierce letters

together with the name in the four directions.

Using the fourth vowel letter,

place it above the head of each fourth letter —

three circuits of this is auspicious.

The wheel that performs all actions —

the ordinary time for drawing it

and especially the particular divine days and dates —
without yoga it must not be done.

By the specific directions one is to gaze,
the practitioner should understand the accomplishment of the action.

The wheel that performs all actions
is the very essence of all the Sugatas
and is also the secret of the Tathāgata.
Whatever is inserted into this wheel —
even a buddha will certainly perish,
and one who reviles the true Dharma will likewise be pacified,
and a wheel-turning monarch will be brought under control.

Even the asuras (demigods) and Pratigha will be pacified by it; even the killing
of an arhat will likewise be appeased; and Śakra (Indra) himself will certainly
be brought under control. Such, then, is this wheel. First it is drawn, and then
beneath it, through faultless blessing applied to that very thing, I should
perform the offering with reverence. For actions performed without offering,
no fruit will arise; and for those done in error, there will be no fruit — only
fruitless exhaustion.

Then the goddess Roḷaṅgma herself rose from her seat, made a great offering,
and uttered this supplication:

What ink is used for drawing the wheel?
What is the writing surface, and what kind of pen?
Are they all the same, or are they different?
May the Blessed One please explain.

The Blessed One declared: "Excellent! Excellent! Therefore listen well, take it
to heart, and I shall explain.

Just as actions are of different kinds,
so too the place for writing and the place for insertion
differ accordingly — thus accomplish the wheel.
The inks too differ, like different grains.

If one wishes to protect a great city,
or if one wishes to protect a man,
use bark of Grogā and likewise of Ubhiśun,
or bark of bhūrja-skin birch,

or on cloth with teeth — the wheel
is to be accompanied by the words of invocation.

Into a bowl of fresh soma
insert the wheel with pure honey placed in the center.
Bind it well with white thread.
The next morning, facing east,
make offering with white flowers,
and visualize oneself as white in color.
In front, visualize a man born under the moon,
with all the directions arrayed before one.
The buddhas dwelling in the ten directions
pour down a stream of water from vases
filled with the five ambrosias (nectars) and perform the empowerment.
Thereafter recite the mantra.
Preceded by svāhā, it carries the words of invocation.

For women, use civet;
at the four outer boundaries drive away obstructors with kīlas (ritual stakes).
Above, draw the crest-line.
The rest follows as for a man.

In particular, if one wishes to pacify a man
or likewise a woman,
write the wheel-letters on bark of the Śirīṣa tree
using camphor and sandalwood.
Facing east, in the morning, make offering.

For the method of performing all actions,
arrange the face drawn earlier as previously described.
At the four outer boundaries drive away obstructors with kīlas.
Above, draw the crest-line.

The vase should have a mouth ornament
and contain precious grain and medicinal substances,
filled with fragrant water.
Tie a fine cloth around its neck.
Place it in the four directions.
Offer to the painted scroll or maṇḍala
with incense, water, flowers,

and pour in water mixed with an offering of blended herbs.
Perform a fire offering (homa) with a thousand hollow vessels.
Scatter that water as well.

For seven days without interruption,
in this way continually offer torma.

Afterward, that precious wheel
is to be drawn out from within the vase.
Attached to the top of a victory banner,
it should be placed in a high location.
It will bring pacification — of that there is no doubt.

With the previously described tree bark
and a charnel-ground cloth, by the sādḥaka,
draw the wheel with juice of emblic myrobalan (yungwa / āmalaka).

Into a fresh bowl of soma
insert the footprint-earth of the one to be acted upon,
earth from the bank where Vairocana's waters flow,
earth from mountains and from crossroads and paths.
Knead them together with juice of lodoños and āmalaka
and fashion into a form.

Roll two wheels together with āmalaka and lodoños juice and anoint them.
Place this against the heart and insert it.

Apply a kīla of seng-leng wood, eight finger-widths long,
to the body and the rest.

Dig a hole on the road by which the enemies will come
and insert it there.

From Laṃ arises the Great Sovereign (Mahādeva, i.e., Śiva) who presses down,
and from Suṃ arises the man — above him,
pressed down by the wheel of various actions —
bind the bowl with yellow thread.

The great kings too, yellow,
dwelling in the south of Mahādeva, facing south:
imagining that one is pressing down the yellow class of the object of action,
begin the recitation.

Without svāhā: Stambhaya!

Recite the mantra suffixed with Laṃ five thousand times.
Continually offer torma.

Through this act of great freezing-in-place (paralysis),
even an army's forces will certainly be frozen.
What need is there to speak of anything lesser?

Praised three times with a humming sound,
draw the wheel on charnel-ground cloth.
One who is seized by plague and poison —
place it upon them.
Visualize oneself as white,
perform the ritual gesture, and blow upon them.
They will thereby be pacified.

If one desires to make speech arrogant and maddened:
mix the fluid that causes madness, charnel-ground charcoal,
and excrement together, leaving it fresh and raw.
On two bowls, draw this wheel —
in the two directions corresponding to male and female —
written correctly, then joined face to face,
smeared with the ashes of a cremated corpse.
Reciting and propagating above:
Stambhana! Kuru lam!
By this mantra, recited without svāhā,
the mouth will certainly be bound.

For one who is to be killed,
a compassionate person
should perform this fierce action —
through the yoga of the deity who is the enemy of death —
accomplishing it with a single act.
At the fourteenth day, at midday,
with a quill from the root feathers of a crow,
write on charnel-ground cloth
with poison, salt, trifoliate nightshade,
the three pungent spices of neem,
hot butter, charnel-ground charcoal,
and the blood of the ring finger that causes madness.
Together with the ashes of a cremated corpse
and the footprint of the one to be effected,
make a form from powdered human bone and the like,

and insert it into the chest of that form.
Turning it over in the charnel-ground fire,
with a mind of wrath, reciting ten thousand times —
in a mere instant, death will come.
Conceal it in that person's home or in the charnel ground.
Through such an action it will be accomplished.
At midnight, face south.
Visualize oneself as a terrifying form:
the face and so forth as previously described —
upon a buffalo, gnashing fangs,
a vast belly, hair blazing upward,
body hair and everything else likewise,
from each pore of the body
blazing forth many wrathful ones
bearing various terrifying weapons.
Visualize oneself blazing like the fire at the end of an eon.
Imagine before you the one to be effected,
possessed of the completed sins of the five heinous acts,
that defiled one wearing the garments of the cardinal directions,
who harms living beings in cities,
whose body is swollen from cold touch,
who has been pierced by weapons —
imagine beasts of prey and the like eating them before you.
Recite verbally in that way again and again.
Bind the limbs with an iron embrace,
pierce them with thorns,
imagine them without skin on their body.
Anoint the body with trifoliate nightshade and saline brine,
imagine the sound of crying and moaning.
Having thereby cleared away their protectors and refuge,
place them at the bottom of Yama's stomach —
one who holds a club shall devour them.
Through being killed in this way, that one
will be born as a son of the buddhas.
They will be freed from the evil of their karma's actions.
The mantra for propagating the killing rite:
Hūṃ! Che ge mo! Māra ya! Hūṃ!

Regarding the division of the inner substances of the one to be effected:
the hide of a buffalo or a horse,
or else a corpse or charnel-ground cloth,
mixed with the blood of a horse, buffalo, cat,
or domestic bird, together with trifoliate nightshade —
draw this wheel upon that.

Providing the impelling words,
place it inside a horse's skull
and inside a buffalo's hoof.

Recite until ten thousand are complete.
Smear with neem wood paste, then conceal it inside.
Within that, conflict itself,
and battle cut off for a hundred leagues, will arise.
Anu ki! Amu ki! Vidveṣaya phaṭ!

For causing a plague to strike:
on a large charnel-ground skull,
draw the wheel with the leaves of the arka plant,
chitraka, trifoliate nightshade, and blood.
Having made the drawing, fill it with the design.
Kindle it on many-petaled acacia leaves,
and with wrath recite five hundred times.
Concealed at the crossroads of a house or road,
or in the charnel ground, plague will seize.

For one who desires the enriching rite to expand:
on a birchbark scroll with civet-musk,
draw two wheels, writing them distinctly.
Write the letters with the impelling words.
For six months in front of a scroll-painting,
the yakṣas and yakṣiṇīs
will shower down a rain of jewels.

Meditating that the yellow death-enemy (Yamāntaka) dwells in the yellow
moon, and reciting ten thousand times, one will come to resemble the noble
Vaiśravaṇa, lord of wealth.

The mantra is: Oṃ che ge mo puṣṭiṃ kuru oṃ.

For writing on sheets of bark from the birch tree and similar plants: write with
civet-musk and wild-grown flowers. Or else mix yellow orpiment with blood,

the juice of bael leaves, an infusion of red cloth, and lac, and write with that mixture. Roll up the wheel with monkey fat. Place it in a vase containing honey. At the four times of day, make offerings of red flowers. The mantra for recitation at that time is: Hoḥ vāśaṃ kuru hoḥ. By this, the gods themselves will assuredly be brought under one's power.

For writing on skulls: write at the time of a lunar eclipse or on a day ruled by a victorious star constellation. Wind the wheel with red thread. Make offerings of red flowers. Place the writing inside two skulls joined face to face, and recite ten thousand times. Through this, one will assuredly obtain even a daughter of the great Śakra, king of the gods.

For writing on charnel-ground cloth: draw the wheel with saffron and the like. Encircle the letters with dots. Using the word amukhī and māmakī, mohanā, and the dispersal syllables, fasten it well at the hem of the garment of the one to be accomplished, meditating on it as the very nature of the dharmadhātu, basic space of phenomena. If one then recites while walking about, one will be unseen by gods and asuras.

Meditating on oneself as the death-enemy himself, if one wishes to walk upon water, one will travel above it in the subtle form of a divine being, and will assuredly proceed upward. By Oḍḍiyāna oneself, one will travel above. For others as well: a young woman should wind a cord on a wool cloth from the forest, and arrange it in a triple coil. Having fully completed the thousand fierce mantras, recite them at the time of the victorious constellation, as previously explained for the method of recitation. The day of writing is likewise at that time. Examining this as the deity of the maṇḍala, tying it on the left side, attach it to another. Without exception, it causes all weapons to be roused, and causes naked bulls to be roused. Other than flowers, nothing else is used.

Pills made of the five meats and the like: dry them well in shade. Wind them with three iron strands. When reciting and making offerings, shape them in the form of silver. Even when they are ablaze, make the offerings properly, and circumambulate many hundreds of times. Thereupon, the wise practitioner, merely by placing this in the mouth, will accomplish whatever is desired. When it is taken out again, it returns to its original natural state. Wash the mechanism with milk as one would care for it. The mantric mechanism is freed, and it abides in its natural state.

For seeds of the granting-of-oils: anoint them with fish scales, musk-rat, and fluid. Filling the ground completely with skulls, conceal it and recite a countless number of times. At that time, gathering in the offerings, torma, and all fully ripened fruits, placing them in the mouth, one becomes a doer of ḍākinī deeds.

Concerning this, it is said: the fierce practices arising from questions, the past, and the present; the meditative absorption of direct realization; the maṇḍala elaborated in detail; the palace measured out by cords; the colored sand examined from each direction; the genuine bestowal of blessing; the tasting of nectar; the meditation on the four divine abodes of Brahmā; the mantra's non-substantiality and its corresponding boundaries; the arising of Dharma and the practitioner; the recitation and its numerical measure; the wheel and the two letters; the precise questions and offerings; the marks for drawing the wheel; the four elements together with the gathering rites and the rest; the vow, the writing of the wheel's letters; the ground, along with the ink; and the distinct delineation of each activity — all of this I have taught in condensed form.

Then the Blessed One entered into the meditative absorption called Satisfying the Elemental Spirits with Torma, and from his vajra body, vajra speech, and vajra mind, he uttered this mantra:

Om hrīḥ ṣyīḥ vikṛtānana hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ svāhā.

Dispersed among the elemental spirits, the final combination applied is:

Hi hi hi hūṃ phem phem phem svāhā.

Adorned with charnel-ground ornaments, resplendent in form —
To you, Vajra of Aversion, the Lord of Death's executioner,
who from the expanse free of all conceptual elaboration, like space itself,
manifests an emanation body through the skillful means of compassion —
To your body wreathed in the dark smoke of gnosis-fires, the terrifying
sovereign of wrathful wisdom, I bow.

Possessing the nine moods of dance,
Vajra of Delusion, executioner of the Lord of Death,
who from the ultimate expanse of unborn reality
is revealed in an emanation body of skillful means,
wearing the fierce and terrifying guise —
To you, bright as a fish-eye moon, I bow.

Blazing like the fire at the end of an age,
Vajra of Miserliness, the Lord of Death's own thunderbolt,
who, freed from the grasper,
emanates as a wrathful one in order to tame the malicious —
To you, Betsoma, golden and resplendent, who liberates from the grip of
miserliness, I bow.

Vajra of Desire, the Lord of Death's sovereign, who holds sway over all through
passion,
who from the unborn, perfectly pure dharmadhātu
emanates as a wrathful being to tame the three realms —
To your form like a bindu, eyes unattached yet filled with compassion, I bow.

Heruka, endowed with wisdom and skillful means,
Vajra of Jealousy, the Lord of Death's executioner,
who from the nature free from all conceptual thought and beyond analogy
manifests as a wrathful emanation through compassion,
bearing the sword that strives for the welfare of beings,
of manifold colours —
To you, I bow.

Great Goddess who gives rise to all,
who acts as the sovereign equalizer,
endowed with eyes that behold the three realms,
making your form resplendent with light, striking terror into the four māras,
ever joyful in great bliss,
bearing the eye of gnosis —
To you, I bow.

Precious Gathering Goddess,
though free from the faults of conceptual thought,
you make the Sugatas of the three times your own.
Your beautiful form crowned with a jewel-pinnacle,
your mind penetrating ultimate reality, dispelling saṃsāra —
To you, sovereign of all without exception, I bow.

You who incinerate all that is conditioned,
who from the nature of pacified conceptuality
liberates all the three realms without remainder,
splendid with Amitābha's glory,
holding in hand, unattached,

the one who purifies enlightened activity —
To you, I bow.

Of a nature that stirs with compassion,
liberating all three worlds,
arising from the expanse of non-dual great bliss,
of the nature of accomplished enlightened activity,
taming beings while abiding in equanimity —
To you, sovereign of all-encompassing activity, I bow.

Thus the individual and complete praises were offered to Vajra of Form and the rest.

Then the Lord of All declared "Excellent!" and, bowing to the forms of the goddesses, spoke:

The fourteen letters of the wrathful and terrifying syllables
are to be visualized either as arrayed in a ring
or as if arising upon the disc of the sun.

Visualize them thus, without distraction, without forgetting.

Recitation is to be performed in this way.

By completing ten million recitations,

there is no activity throughout all of infinite space that will not be
accomplished —

all things are accomplished through this.

Even a hundred thousand or a million recitations
will bring about the subtler activities.

With a mind that does not wander elsewhere,
recitation is to be performed in this manner.

When the mind goes off to other objects,
even an aeon of recitation will yield no fruit.

Recite this with a mind that does not scatter,
and for the one who has entered the path,
there will be no fear from tigers, water, or the like.

Now, what must truly be explained:

one who is excellently endowed with a well-trained mind for empowerment —
without obtaining the result, it cannot be accomplished;
therefore that must be explained.

First, one is ripened by the vase empowerment (abhiṣeka);
second is the secret empowerment;
the third is precisely wisdom-gnosis empowerment;
and just so the fourth is likewise.

At the very time of meditation on all things, moving and still, without exception,

one must not meditate with the discursive mind alone.

If the characteristics of all are not understood,
that alone is not genuine meditation.

But when the actual nature of all things is fully known,
that is proclaimed to be complete meditation.

This is to be received from the lips of the guru,
striven for diligently, and that guru is not to be disparaged.

From that, everything arises.

One who is deceitful and treacherous toward the guru —
certainly such a person, through the full force of poisons
and all manner of great malevolent spirits without exception,
will perish and be utterly destroyed,
falling into the hells for a long time,
suffering through many aeons,
and will forever cry out in lamentation.

Therefore, to one of great intelligence —

one should never disparage another, but rather
toward all beings, with a mind of loving respect and humility,
act in exactly that way with a heart of benefit.

Furthermore, one should indeed meditate:

for those who travel the path of the faculties,
one should act in accordance with each one's own nature.

Do not perform meditative concentration with the ordinary mind;
with wisdom-mind, practise meditation at all times.

The Blessed One, the Great Lord, then called upon Vajrapāṇi and spoke this secret melody:

"Form, sound, and the remaining six sense objects (viṣayas),
arising from the objectless expanse like space,
appear as the manifold objects of enjoyment —
just as colour appears in crystal.

May one always practise the yoga
of the five sense pleasures and all phenomena.
Alala ho! Let it be tasted! Let it be taken up!
In what does not grasp, like an illusion,
take delight in the dance of joy!
In awareness that has no object to be negated,
take delight while remaining utterly still!
Ho! Through non-attachment, be attached!

Then, in order to explain fully what is right
and to explain the defining marks of mantra, mudrā, and empowerment,
the speech was declared in these words:

The vajra of meditation on the tongue
is the vajra called Vajra-Harmer-of-the-Beautiful, the dark one.
With the two palms spread wide,
firmly press them together;
at the very joint at the base of the ring finger,
the thumb is to be firmly applied;
the index finger is pressed to the tip of the back of the ring finger.
This is the samaya mudrā.
With it, bless the heart, the forehead, the throat, and the crown:
Om hrīḥ śrīḥ vikṛtānana hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ adhitiṣṭha svāṃ.

Furthermore, with the mudrā of Vajrasattva and the rest,
one confers empowerment — examine the crown ornament.
With Moha-vajra and the like,
each is crowned by their respective lord,
and at the time of empowerment, a great vase
is taken in the hand and empowerment is conferred.

To the one who performs all actions through the wheel (cakra),
Vajrapāṇi of the secret empowerment
offers this praise with this royal hymn of praise:

You who terrify the cruel, whose wheel blazes like fire,
you who are the heart of Heruka, the wrathful king of the three times,
you who purify all actions, Vajra of Envy —
with your body you sever the sinews of all without exception when
supplicated;

with your speech you are united with the fierce force of Hūṃ and Phaṭ;
you know the intrinsic nature of all: at Yama's belly,
taking your seat by the command, I too shall not transgress,
and you who summon beings from your abode through emanations in the ten
directions —
to you, the supreme great wheel that performs all things without exception,
accomplishing the welfare of others, I bow in devotion!

You are the hero, the māra of all the great sages (munis).
Though I have shown the path and the māras cannot sever it,
for one who transgresses the pledges and generates all that is wrong,
you too must not transgress the command — accomplish the actions!
Bind life and breath, and fetter the limbs!
If the yogi who is the stream of nectar desires to accomplish wishes for me,
I shall grant them; but you — do not transgress the pledge!"

This is to be done at the time that is not a permanent installation when one
wishes
to take up residence in the belly of the dark wheel of the glorious enemy of
Yama.

When one visualises the wheel at the heart,
with a seed syllable, likewise at the navel,
all the letters, and all desires as well,
are freed from the conceptuality of defective characteristics.
From the three-edged essential nature,
Kṣaṇ is the identity of that which is exhausted;
U is the very identity of Hūṃ —
and that is the very intrinsic nature of mind,
the primordial wisdom transcending joy.
Through the union of method with wisdom,
through the identity of teaching the timely method,
it is attained — and otherwise it is not attained.

By the great riverbank, at the edge and
in charnel grounds, at the foot of trees, in hermitages,
in solitary places and in the abode of the Mothers —
there, strive for this protector.
If you strive elsewhere, it will not be accomplished.

In that very instant, know that all intrinsic natures
will certainly not appear, and that there is no path of awareness.

That fruit is vast indeed —
it is precisely the attainment of the ultimate.

Then once more, the Sugata, lord of all, proclaimed the ritual of the vajra
ground. At that, the Protector — guardian of all buddhas — spoke these words:

By the conduct and distinction
of the practice of all buddhas,
you, O goddess, have sovereignty
over the grounds and the perfections.

Dwelling perfectly in the protective maṇḍala,
he spoke thus to dispel
those of hostile misdirection
and all obstructors:

I, the glorious one, am Vajradhara.
By perfectly engaging the wheel of protection,
I — with the wisdom vajra —
body, speech, and mind included,
the very self of all buddhas,
the wrathful one, lord of dark Yamāntaka —
let the master draw the maṇḍala.

This is to be recited up to three times.

Right before the maṇḍala,
to one whose face is covered with silk,
standing at the threshold —
the master addresses that one clearly,
and that one is declared to be a fortunate recipient.

Just as the supreme hero
confers empowerment upon a protector,
I too ask the protector
to confer empowerment upon me,
that I may dwell in supreme awakening.

Flowers and the like — the finest of offerings —
an inexhaustible ocean without remainder:

the master, himself that very hero,
again and again makes offerings
and assembles praises to that one,
satisfying him thoroughly and extensively.
Thereafter the hero bestows empowerments upon that one.

Then the great king of great bliss,
the hero endowed with every enjoyment,
he who strives for the welfare of beings, lord of the three bodies,
himself proclaimed this:

Without fire offering, no fruit is produced.
Therefore the noble practitioner
must apply effort to that activity.

Adorned with black garments and ornaments,
with a gaze like Yamārāja,
the yogin sits in the wrathful cross-legged posture
upon a firm seat.

The activities are to be accomplished
at midnight or at midday.

In the fire maṇḍala arisen from raṃ,
with hūṃ phaṭ at the outer edge,
from the beginning through the middle to the end of the mantra,
perform the fire offering. That fire —
whether it comes from a charnel-ground fire, or from bone,
or from stone itself,
or from the hearth of a caṇḍālī woman —
in the triangular fire pit,
cast in thorny firewood,
fan it with wind, light it, and recite: hūṃ jvala raṃ, jvala hūṃ — so reciting,
kindle the fire.

With the right hand holding kuśa grass,
press the thumb against the base of the ring finger.
Recite: oṃ ehy ehi mahābhūta deva ṛṣi dvija sattama gṛhītvā āhūti āhāra
asminn sannihito bhava,
and so invoke the presence.

In the very midst of the blazing fire —
one named "the Destroyer of Names,"
wrathful, resplendent as fire,
with hair standing on end in just that way,
looking upward with a smoke-colored sidelong eye,
roaring loudly, possessing four fangs, of great power,
abiding in the wind maṇḍala arisen from yaṃ,
he recites the fierce syllables.

Three-eyed, four-armed,
well-established in the seats of awareness,
seven-faced, terrifying — upon a great buffalo,
wreathed in dense clusters of smoke.
Two hands hold a spear and vajra,
two hold a sword and a curved knife.
To that one's right side,
or equally to the front,
the invoked and consecrated one is to be worshipped
with argham and the rest.
oṃ arghaṃ prātīccha svāhā.

With the right hand's forefinger and thumb
formed into the shape of something dry,
take up water and move it, presenting it.
oṃ pādyaṃ — recite this at the end as before.

For washing the feet, with auspiciousness —
a ritual ladle of sixteen finger-widths in handle,
or else four fingers, with a foot of two fingers,
the corners three, with a center of two fingers' measure,
encircled entirely by a triple-pointed garland.
In the center as well there is a mark —
a tiger or serpent, as desired, as emblem.
The spout drops nectar the width of one finger.
It is the shape of the vajra beak of the wrathful one,
consecrated, measuring one finger.

A pouring ladle with a handle of fourteen finger-widths,
at the foot one finger, triangular —

at the tip of the handle, triple-pointed —
that elevated ladle blessed for wrathful action,
I have described.

Of meteoric iron with thorns, and woods of that kind —
making the fire-offering vessel from these, the buddhas tremble.
Burning the substances, images, and the like —
a vessel empty and hollow in a thousand ways
does not produce results with certainty.

At the left root is the filling ladle;
at the right is the pouring ladle.
Its mouth is a lotus petal,
spreading to two fingers in measure.

The vajra skull-cups in between
serve as vessels for the burning substances.
The substances — vajra, jewel, glory —
are bounded by the syllables Hūṃ and Phaṭ.

That which is to be burned — earth, water, fire, and wind —
abides at the center, like unto space itself.
It remains ever with its mouth open,
and should always be circumambulated with mouth open.

Upon the eight petals of the four-and-two,
together with the navel properly placed,
the deity of simultaneous consciousness
burns without fail in the nature of space itself.
What is to be known as its characteristic mark
is precisely that, in the form of a particle —
a bindu without syllable,
abiding in unceasing light.

Cut into one hundred parts by the measure of a hair,
the fire-offering is to be kindled with great intensity.

With the four elements as previously stated,
together with space as the fifth element assured,
with five fingers exactly determined —
let the fire-offering be performed by whoever does so.
Others perform the burning with three fingers.
All objects of visualization become blocked.

Without support, empty like space —
the great seal (mahāmudrā) of the Perfection of Wisdom
comes under one's power.

Becoming equal to all the Sugatas,
through wisdom and compassion in their fullness,
one becomes a phenomenon of unobstructed cessation.

Great bliss like space —
this is the object of the yogin's meditation.

Of a dark color, like unto eight petals,
the hearth is broad and deep, twenty fingers wide, likewise ten,
with the tip facing north.

The mark of the vajra hammer
is to be drawn four fingers in size.
Upon that, three fingers are to be thrown off.
Even carrying the rim, that is the measure.

Black soil, female donkey dung,
husk of human bone-marrow fruit,
smeared entirely with charcoal powder,
worshiped with foul odor and fumigation.
Charnel-ground wood, or donkey and female donkey dung
as dry fuel-wood —

lower by one finger.
Neem, likewise khadira,
likewise lac-wood,
and charnel-ground small wood of ten fingers,
derived from a portion of the root,
smeared with charnel-ground grease —
that is what serves as the stirring-stick.

Wings of crow and owl,
ashes of neem leaves,
footprint soil, donkey and female donkey dung and the like,
hair, fat, and excrement,
urine, human bones, white mustard,
mustard oil, blood, and salt —
these and such things, one by one,
whatever substances are obtained —

poison, blood, and madness-inducing
leaf juice, ash, charcoal,
heaps of rice husks, and the like —
making the image of one's enemies from these,
beginning from the head, cutting with a sword
into pieces, into an iron bowl,
with blood, water, persons,
and donkey urine, bearing the syllable Phaṭ —
reciting the malefic syllables,
fumigating and presenting tormas to the substances,
this one who bears hatred and delusion toward the master
should be addressed and offered in the fire-sacrifice.

Therein the following is declared:
the tormas for satisfying elemental spirits,
praise and recitation for pleasing them,
the exposition of the divisions of empowerment,
entering into the maṇḍala,
worship of its ground, and so forth —
placing the Sugatas as a crown.
The ritual of wrathful fire-sacrifice,
and in brief, eight aspects in between.

A neck white as a white lotus, long,
the form beautiful, not excessively tall,
dust arising on the body, captivating,
the fragrance most excellent.
The gaze of the eyes and such like those of a deer,
the throat and belly likewise those of a deer —

The auspicious waist likewise is that of a deer.
She swells greatly like an elephant in rut,
intoxicated, her breasts fully developed.
Yet further, regarding conventional truth:
she is short-limbed, her hair also short,
her hands and feet long, her face long,
she has the smell of fish, long-limbed,
her birth-place exceedingly long, like the moon,
the birth-place small, the limbs rough.

The long-limbed one likewise has firm breasts,
fine hair, speaking slowly, small limbs.
That one of blue-green hue, her markings even —
I have proclaimed her as a vidyā
in the two aspects of secret wisdom.

She who moves with a swan's gait, her hair curled,
her face round, her breasts full, her body also full,
not excessively tall, speaking slowly,
with pendant ears from the middle, bearing three wrinkles,
her marks poor and her laziness great,
her limbs dark and her hair curled,
dwelling indoors, her body rough,
emitting the fragrance of rice, smelling of rice,
her breasts pendulous — she is like a man,
a brave woman intoxicated with beer,
one who is extremely fond of beer.

These two are auspicious for that purpose —
certainly and without doubt, in the last degree.
That very samādhi of death
I regard as supreme bliss.
In that too this very bliss is found.

The vowels from which ka and the rest are excluded —
these are sixteen, being two groups,
and are the seeds of the cakras and so forth.
Those lunar ones number thirty-two.
The consonants from which ā and the rest are excluded,
seventeen in number: the second,
above that, those that are not excluded from ya and the rest —
of the third, three; of the fourth, two;
four groups of ten, being two groups of those.
The nails, copper, and such are the seeds,
proclaimed for the sun — that one dwells in the center.
From the nature of hūṃ and of a,
the vajra, hammer, and so forth are contemplated separately.
By their dissolving, the intensive wisdom
is the dharmadhātu itself, perfectly pure —

one regards oneself as the enemy of the dead.
The particularities of ornament abide on the body.
This is to be spoken of thus:
the teaching of vidyā and wisdom,
and the particular causes for their generation —
these are shown last: three vows.
That which is the very nature of what illustrates
has what is illustrated as having been shown before.

Here ends the Tantra King of the Wheel that Accomplishes All the Actions of
the Black Yamāntaka. Translated, edited, and established in final form from
before the face of the Paṇḍita Vāro the Maimed, by Ra Vajraghraka.

Translator's Notes

- The title's Sanskrit is given in the text as "Yamāri Kṛṣṇakarma Sarva Cakra Siddha Kara Nāma Tantra Rāja," transliterated from Tibetan rendering of Sanskrit. The Tibetan title glosses "Yamāri" as "the Enemy of the Lord of Death" (gshin rje'i gshed), which is the standard Tibetan rendering.

The term "bhaga" is left in Sanskrit as it is a specific tantric anatomical-ritual term for the female consort's generative center, understood here in the context of the union of all Tathāgatas' body, speech, and mind vajra dwelling in the noble lady Vajra.

"Mahābhairava" (ma he ra gnyis pa, "the second Mahābhairava") is a reference to the Great God (Śiva) in his terrible Bhairava form. The compound "brdzi" suggests a forceful subjugation or striking down, which may carry the sense of sexual union in tantric ritual context; I have rendered it conservatively as "struck down" given the narrative context. A tantric specialist reader may understand a more explicitly sexual connotation.

The mantra "Om Jina Jik" is incomplete as the passage breaks off. This appears to be only the beginning of the mantra, with the remainder either on a following page or missing.

- The passage on maṇḍala construction contains a series of technical instructions for cord-laying and directional orientation that use the term rendered here as "false direction" (literally "direction devoid of truth" or "direction of untruth"). This likely refers to an inauspicious or ritually impure directional axis, possibly the southwest or a direction associated with obstacles, but the precise technical referent is not specified in the text itself and may depend on a commentary tradition.

The "deer-rider" is a standard epithet for Indra or, in some ritual contexts, for Vāyu (the wind deity), who rides a deer. In this maṇḍala-construction context it most likely indicates a specific directional quarter associated with that deity.

- The mantra passages (Om sarva tathāgata kāya vajra svabhāva ātmako'ham, etc.) are standard body-speech-mind vajra-nature mantras found in many tantric contexts; they are rendered here in normalized transliteration as they appear. The first ends in ātmako'ham ("I am the self/nature"), standard self-identification formula.

The phrase rendered "Delusion Vajra" translates a compound where the Moha-vajra (one of the family-emblematic vajras) serves as a protective deity for the eye and other faculties in the context of sense-faculty consecration.

The "rekhā lines" refers to the geometric lines (rekhā, Skt.) that structure the maṇḍala's divisions; the term is left lightly glossed as "rekhā lines" since it is a technical drawing term without a clean English equivalent.

The "fourteen sets of ten million each" for mantra recitation is a highly specific enumeration; the Tibetan bcu bzhi suggests the number 140 million total or fourteen times ten million as the full count for accomplishment.

- The passage on "slaying phenomena" and "slaying that which is without form" reflects a tantric antinomian register in which conventional ethical categories are reframed in terms of yogic realization: destroying reified mental constructs and afflictions, not literal killing. The commentary tradition consistently interprets this passage in that light.

The phrase rendered "the fourteen fierce letters" refers to the fourteen consonants classified in tantric yantra-writing systems as the harsh or violent phonemes; their precise enumeration varies by tradition.

The line "from Bhruṃ arises the palace-mansion endowed with twelve spokes" has the hub and the number of spokes in an unusual configuration; the text is syntactically compressed and this rendering follows the most natural grammatical reading.

- "Pratigha" in the first line renders རྒྱུ་མཁའ་ལྷོ་མཁའ་ — this is likely a corrupt or abbreviated form for a class of beings associated with the asuras; the compound རྒྱུ་མཁའ་ལྷོ་མཁའ་ may be a transcription of Sanskrit Pratigha used as a proper name or epithet for a wrathful asura-type being. The exact referent is uncertain and may be a deity name within the ritual tradition.

"Groga" and "Ubhiśun" are transcriptions of Sanskrit botanical terms (possibly Granthika and Vibhītaka or similar); the precise botanical identifications are uncertain.

"Lodoños" renders ལོ་དོ་ནོ་སོ་, likely a Tibetan term for a plant (possibly Terminalia or similar); not definitively identified.

"Seng-leng" (སེང་ལེང་) is Acacia or a related thorny tree used in ritual kīlas — the precise identification varies by tradition.

The phrase རྒྱུ་མཁའ་ལྷོ་མཁའ་ rendered as "great freezing-in-place" corresponds to the Sanskrit Stambhana (paralysis/immobilization rite), which is confirmed by the mantra Stambhaya immediately preceding — this is one of the four or six standard magical actions of tantric ritual.

- The passage contains a self-contained antinomian rationale for the killing rite: the slain person is reborn as a "son of the buddhas" and freed from their evil karma. This is a standard apologetic formula found in wrathful tantric ritual literature, justifying the rite as an act of compassion (karuṇā) toward a being of extreme negative karma — it should not be read as ordinary doctrinal advocacy of killing.

The term rendered "finger that causes madness" translates a compound literally meaning "the ring finger associated with the maddening substance," a standard identification in ritual literature.

"Anu ki, Amu ki" are seed-syllable or placeholder elements typical of encoded mantra notation; they are transliterated as they stand.

The phrase rendered "garments of the cardinal directions" is a recognized formulaic description of nakedness in wrathful ritual contexts, meaning the target wears nothing but the sky.

- The epithet རྩམ་ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་, literally "the yellow enemy of death," is a form of Yamāntaka, the wrathful bull-headed deity who conquers Yama, lord of death. The color yellow here specifies a particular iconographic form. This rendering is consistent with Vajrayāna usage.

The term འམུཁྱི་ (amukhī) and related terms in the fascicle of binding syllables are left in their mantra form as they are untranslatable seed-syllables or mantra phrases rather than semantic Tibetan.

The passage རྩམ་ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་ rendered as "for writing on skulls" reflects one plausible reading of རྩམ་ལྷ་མོ་ (a vessel made from a skull-cap); the alternative "on pots or cups" is possible but the charnel-ground ritual context strongly supports the skull reading.

The phrase འམུཁྱི་ལྷ་མོ་ and འམུཁྱི་ལྷ་མོ་ are mantra vocatives of goddesses (amukhī, māmākī, mohanā) used in enchantment rites; they are left untranslated as ritual proper names.

- The term "Betsoma" rendered directly from the Tibetan "བེ་སྐྱེ་མ་" is a deity name specific to this tantric context. It appears to designate one of the wrathful goddesses (associated with the Vajra of Miserliness); the name is retained in transliterated form as its Sanskrit equivalent is not supplied in the text and remains uncertain.

The phrase "like a fish-eye moon" renders "ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་" literally. This may refer to a crescent moon resembling the eye of a fish, a conventional tantric simile for a particular luminous form; it is left as translated.

The text ends mid-sentence with "therefore, to one of great intelligence," indicating the passage continues beyond the supplied excerpt.

- The passage contains a Sanskrit mantra transcribed into Tibetan syllables: Om hrīḥ śrīḥ vikṛtānana hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ adhiṭṣṭha svāṃ. The syllable vikṛtānana means "disfigured face" or "fierce-faced," consistent with the epithet Vajra-Harmer-of-the-Beautiful (rdorje gnod mdzes nag po) describing a wrathful deity. The Sanskrit reconstruction of this mantra is phonologically based on the Tibetan transcription and may contain minor orthographic variants.

The phrase rendered "the māra of all the great sages" (dpa' bo thub chen kun gyi bdud) is deliberately paradoxical in the tantric register: the wheel-deity is described as the subduer and at once the māra-force operating within the sages, which is a recognized tantric trope for a wrathful protector who both embodies and conquers the māra-principle.

The final lines about Kṣaḥ and U being identities of "exhausted" and Hūṃ respectively reflect a seed-syllable meditation practice whose full technical exposition would require commentary; the rendering follows the grammatical surface and conventional tantric usage.

- The passage contains a series of Sanskrit mantras transliterated into Tibetan. These have been rendered back into standard Sanskrit transliteration as they appear to be liturgical invocation formulae and would be recited as Sanskrit in practice. The phrase rendered "Destroyer of Names" reflects the Tibetan ming de zad byed, a wrathful epithet; this is likely a rendering of a Sanskrit name such as Nāmāntakara or similar. The deity described — three-eyed, four-armed, seven-faced, riding a great buffalo, associated with Yamāntaka and Yamārāja — is a wrathful tantric form; the description is consistent with Kṛṣṇayamāri or a related deity in the Yamāntaka cycle. The passage ends mid-sentence describing the ritual ladle; this appears to be a mid-text break in the source passage.

- The passage contains highly technical ritual instructions for a wrathful fire-sacrifice (homa) ritual within a Vajrayāna context. Several points deserve mention.

The phrase rendered "deity of simultaneous consciousness" translates "lhan cig rnam par shes pa'i lha," a technical term for a deity associated with the coemergent or co-arisen consciousness; this may refer to the innate wisdom deity recognized in the fire of awareness, a concept specific to certain Vajrayāna homa commentaries.

The phrase "bindu without syllable" refers to the subtle luminous point (bindu, thig le) devoid of any seed-syllable support — a technical tantric notion about the nature of the fire in the inner maṇḍala.

The closing lines describing a beautiful, deer-like figure appear to begin a new section describing a woman or deity figure; the passage breaks off mid-description. Consistency with what follows should be maintained by the translator of the next passage.

- This passage belongs to a tantric context involving vidyā-consort description, syllable-counting for maṇḍala seeds, and Yamāntaka practice. Several lists of physical characteristics describe different categories of ritual consorts or vidyā-women, employing conventional Indic erotic physiognomy adapted to tantric ends. The rendering follows the Tibetan closely; the intentionally cryptic and elliptical nature of the syllable-enumeration section (āli-kāli, vowels and consonants in tantric numerology) is inherent to the tantra's intentional obscurity.

The colophon names the Paṇḍita as "Vāro phyag rdum," literally "Vāro the Maimed Hand" or "Vāro the Short-Armed." The Tibetan translator is Ra Vajraghraka (Rwa Rdo rje grags), a historically attested figure of the early translation period. This colophon is doctrinally significant as a witness to the text's transmission lineage.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.